A career of product instinct. Shipping now at AI speed.

Senior Product Manager · Founder, Aleph Co. · 15 years sourcing products globally before building the software the operators actually need.

ABOUT

Fifteen years sourcing products across Asia and the US — at YETI, at Cheng Loong in Shanghai, at AT&T Wireless — taught me what real importers need. Then Senior PM at Gannett/LocaliQ, where I took Scheduling from concept to shipped product inside a media company and picked up SEO and GenAI ownership along the way.

I started using AI for product work early — first for research and competitive analysis, then prototyping, then building entire products. Today I design, prototype, and ship full-stack applications using Claude Code, Cursor, and Gemini. Not prompting for code snippets — architecting systems, writing tests, deploying to production. AI didn't replace the PM skillset; it gave me a way to go from insight to working software without waiting for a sprint.

Now I combine both backgrounds — founding Aleph Co. to build compliance tooling for the sourcers I used to be, while shipping seven other products in parallel because the operator problems I know best aren't confined to one market.

MBA from USC Marshall (2012), CSPO, and a lifetime food blog at The Thirsty Pig. Based in Los Angeles.

EXPERIENCE

Sept 2025 — now
Aleph Co.
Founder & Operator · Los Angeles, CA

Founded and operate Aleph, a B2B SaaS compliance platform for US importers covering FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, and multi-state PFAS regulations.

Ship seven additional products in parallel under Aleph Co. — see Projects.

Mar 2022 — Oct 2024
LocaliQ / USA Today Network
Senior Product Manager · Woodland Hills, CA

Owned Scheduling end-to-end — strategy, roadmap, discovery, launch — leading a cross-functional pod of engineering, design, QA, and Customer Success.

4,900 free + 400 paid accounts in year one against an internal plan projecting meaningfully smaller numbers. 8,000+ booked appointments in the first six months via Google Calendar, Outlook, and SMS integrations.

Expanded scope to LocaliQ's SEO offering and its GenAI/Jasper tooling; defined the KPI and instrumentation layer fed to Sales and CS dashboards across the revenue org.

Dec 2019 — Jun 2020
Sunrise Integration
Product / Project Manager · Los Angeles, CA

Owned WarehouseConnector.com product and integration delivery for OMS/ERP/CRM/WMS workflows used by logistics operators.

Led Magento → Shopify platform migrations and NetSuite ERP modernization initiatives.

Jun 2019 — Nov 2019
Movley (now Ops Ninja)
Product / Operations Manager · Remote

Delivered operational dashboards for manufacturing inspections and overseas fulfillment workflows.

Built and managed distributed operations teams (China, Philippines) supporting U.S. manufacturing customers.

Apr 2018 — Dec 2018
MEDL Mobile
Product / Project Manager · Irvine, CA

Led requirements, QA, and App Store submissions for mobile apps across consumer and emerging-tech engagements.

Coordinated cross-functional delivery for multiple shipped applications under tight timelines with external stakeholders.

2000 — 2017
Earlier · supply chain
YETI · AT&T · Cheng Loong (Shanghai) · Cobalt Skys · Spray Tech · Breeze (Taipei)

Fifteen years sourcing products across Asia and the US — global packaging, telecom, paper, and consumer goods.

This is the operator background that makes Aleph Co. a domain-expert play, not a random SaaS bet.

EDUCATION

USC Marshall School of Business

Master of Business Administration (MBA), 2012. Class President.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), Scrum Alliance · 2019

Product Management Certificate, Product School · 2018

SKILLS

PRODUCT: 0→1 development, roadmapping, discovery & user research, A/B testing, GenAI integration, native-mobile PM
TOOLS: Jira, Linear, Productboard, Figma, Notion, Confluence, Slack, Mixpanel, PostHog, Sentry, Google Analytics 4, Appcues, Stripe, Shopify, GitHub, Postman
AI-ASSISTED ENGINEERING: Claude Code, Cursor, Gemini, ChatGPT Codex, VS Code, Xcode, Replit, MCP · TypeScript, Python, Next.js, React Native/Expo, Astro, Tailwind, FastAPI, Express, Prisma, Drizzle, Socket.IO
INFRASTRUCTURE: Vercel, Railway, Render, Supabase, Neon, TinaCMS, BullMQ/Redis, Playwright, Tesseract.js OCR
DOMAINS: B2B SaaS, regulatory compliance, fantasy sports, food & dining, global supply chain & sourcing
LANGUAGES: English (native), Mandarin (verbal fluency), Taiwanese (verbal fluency)

PROJECTS

Aleph Co.

Product compliance for US importers — FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, multi-state PFAS — one platform.

The Fantastic Leagues

Fantasy baseball with league-context AI. 26 feature modules, 730 tests, 8 AI features (Gemini + Claude), live auction WebSockets.

The Judge Tool

Digital KCBS BBQ competition judging. Real-time tabulation, audit trails, 16,424 LOC + 113 tests shipped in 20 days.

Bahtzang Trader

AI trading-decision experiment using Claude Sonnet. Paper-trading sandbox — not a live trading service.

TableDrop

Modular restaurant operating system — started as a reservation marketplace for Taipei, expanding into POS integration and supply chain. Next.js + Stripe + Playwright.

KTV Singer

YouTube-powered karaoke system. Phone & Apple TV pairing, synced lyrics, shared queue. Expo + SwiftUI + Express + Socket.IO + Supabase.

Tastemakers

iOS restaurant-review app. 1,000+ downloads in 3 months with no paid acquisition. Laravel 8 + PostgreSQL + Redis + Firebase push.

The Thirsty Pig

Food and travel blog since 2007. 2026 rebuild: 923 posts recovered from the Wayback Machine, 1,649 Instagram posts archived, 2,900+ pages.

MEMBERSHIPS & LEADERSHIP

Chinese American Museum BOARD MEMBER

Feb 2026 – Present · Los Angeles, CA

Serving on the board of the Chinese American Museum in downtown Los Angeles, the first museum in the United States dedicated to the history and ongoing story of Chinese Americans.

Kansas City Barbeque Society CERTIFIED BBQ JUDGE (CBJ) · LIFETIME MEMBER

2022 – Present

KCBS-certified Barbeque Judge since 2022. Lifetime member; judged at 12+ sanctioned competitions. The domain knowledge behind building The Judge Tool.

james.chang

los angeles, ca jimmychang316@gmail.com (mailto:jimmychang316@gmail.com)

let's find time to chat (https://calendly.com/jimmychang316/60minvideocall) linkedin (https://www.linkedin.com/in/jimmychang316)

github (https://github.com/thirstypig) résumé.pdf ↓

// © 2026 james chang

// built with claude code · source on github (https://github.com/thirstypig/jameschang.co)